

Rigel 03 2026

Originator: Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited

March 25, 2026

Instrument [#]	Amount (₹ crore)	Structure	Tenure* (months)	Rating ¹	Credit Enhancement ^{\$} (₹ crore)		Rating Action
					Over Collateral	Cash Collateral	
Series A1 PTCs	138.31	Par (TI-UP Conditional Turbo)	23	Provisional CARE AA- (SO)	17.97	10.16	Assigned

Details of instruments/facilities in Annexure-1.

Pass-through certificates (PTCs) are rated based on timely payment of interest and payment of principal on or before the final legal maturity date.

* Tenure / door-to-door maturity may change due to prepayments or changes in interest rates.

\$ Excess interest spread (EIS) shall flow back to the originator per waterfall mechanism

Rating in the absence of pending steps/documents	No rating can be assigned
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Rationale and key rating drivers

CARE Ratings Limited (CareEdge Ratings) has assigned a rating of 'Provisional CARE AA- (SO)' [pronounced as 'Double A Minus (Structured Obligation)'] to Series A1 PTCs, proposed to be issued by Rigel 03 2026 backed by microfinance loan receivables originated by Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited ("the Originator" or "SSFL").

The rating is based on credit quality of underlying loans, support in the form of credit enhancement (CE), credit underwriting and servicing capability of the originator, well-defined payment mechanism, and robust legal structure of the transaction.

The final rating will be assigned after copies of following documents, duly executed in accordance with the structure and to the satisfaction of CareEdge Ratings, are furnished by the originator:

- Assignment agreement
- Trust deed
- Power of attorney
- A legal opinion from an independent legal counsel
- Due diligence audit report
- Any other documents executed for the transaction.

Rating sensitivities: Factors likely to lead to rating actions

Positive factors - Factors that could, individually or collectively, lead to positive rating action/upgrade:

- Delinquencies (90+ days past due [DPD] as percentage of initial principal outstanding [POS]) of less than 2% and sustained high collection efficiency (cumulative collection efficiency of over 98%).
- Sustained build-up of cash collateral (CC) of over 2x the initial proposed (as a percentage of the balance POS).

Negative factors - Factors that could, individually or collectively, lead to negative rating action/downgrade:

- Delinquencies (90+ DPD as percentage of initial POS) of over 8% and sustained lower collection efficiency (cumulative collection efficiency of less than 90%).
- Utilisation of CC.
- Deterioration in credit profile of the originator.
- Non-adherence to key transaction terms envisaged at the time of the rating.

Analytical approach

The rating is based on inter alia, analysis of underlying pool of receivables, expected pool performance, performance of originator's portfolio and transaction structure including the proposed credit enhancement (CE).

¹Complete definitions of ratings assigned are available at www.careratings.com and in other CARE Ratings Limited's publications.

Detailed description of key rating drivers

The transaction is structured at par and the Series A1 PTCs are rated for timely payment of interest with repayment of principal on or before the final legal maturity. The transaction has a conditional turbo amortisation feature. EIS shall be utilised per the waterfall mechanism.

The assigned pool consists of over 32,400 microfinance loan contracts, aggregating to a principal outstanding of ₹156.28 crore as on the cut-off date. Top three states account for ~55% of the pool. All contracts are current on payment. The pool has weighted an average seasoning of ~5 months with an amortisation of ~18%. Around 90% contracts in the pool have a credit bureau score (CRIF) of over 700. The pool is granular with schedule of cash flows from underlying loans. Assignment of receivables to the special purpose vehicle (SPV) lends strength to these cash flows and the rating factors terms of servicing agreement as detailed hereinafter.

The CE will comprise CC of 6.50%, subordinated over collateral (OC) of 11.50%, and subordination of EIS of ~15% of the pool POS in the structure. The CC will be in the form of fixed deposits (FDs) with a lien marked in favour of the trust, per CareEdge Ratings' criteria. The support of OC and EIS is subject to realisation. The EIS is also subject to compression considering prepayments in the pool. Cash flow from the underlying pool, and external CE, will be used to make payout to PTC investors.

Key strengths:

- Robustness of transaction structure and well-defined payment mechanism.
- CE comprising CC, subordinated OC and EIS.
- No overdue contracts as on the pool cut-off date; all contracts are ever current as on the pool cut-off date.
- Underwriting policies and collection capabilities of SSFL.
- Moderate weighted average seasoning (based on equated monthly instalments [EMIs] paid) of ~5 months with amortisation of ~18% as of pool cut-off date.

Key weakness:

- Weak borrower profile as this segment is susceptible to socio-political interference and other external shocks.

Liquidity: Strong

Inherent liquidity in the structure is strong. Interest payouts for Series A1 PTCs are promised monthly, while principal of Series A1 PTCs is promised to be paid by final legal maturity. In case of delinquency, payouts are expected to be supported by CE consisting of CC, principal subordination in the form of OC and EIS.

Key rating assumptions and adequacy of credit enhancement:

CareEdge Ratings has analysed the transaction to assess whether the CE is sufficient to cover shortfalls. Since the transaction is sensitive to credit quality of the underlying pool, CareEdge Ratings has analysed performance of static pools provided by the originator and overall portfolio performance of the originator. Considering borrower profile, nature of loan, pool characteristics, and portfolio performance, CareEdge Ratings has taken average shortfall at 7.00-9.00% of the POS. Base case shortfalls were stressed along with other key factors, such as timing of shortfalls, recovery assumptions, and time to recovery. Pool cash flow has been further adjusted for prepayments of underlying loans, assuming monthly prepayments in the range of 0.50-1.00%. CareEdge Ratings has stipulated CE, which is commensurate with credit rating of PTCs.

Key risks, concerns and mitigants:

The securitisation transaction involves several risks, including credit risk from borrower defaults, commingling risk due to time lags in fund deposits, basis risk from differing interest rate benchmarks, prepayment risk from early principal repayments, servicer bankruptcy risk, legal risk regarding the validity of receivable transfers, and counterparty risk involving transaction parties. These risks are factored while assigning rating, wherever needed, and partially mitigated through credit enhancements, separate record-keeping, credit rating/profile of the originator, transaction structuring, true sale of receivables, legal opinion from independent legal counsel. The transaction structure also has provision to change counterparties including trustee, and banker among others.

Applicable criteria

[Policy on Default Recognition](#)

[Assignment of Provisional rating](#)

[CARE Ratings' methodology for asset/mortgage-backed securitisation](#)

Validity of provisional rating

Provisional rating shall be converted into a final rating after receipt of transaction documents duly executed/ completion of mentioned steps within 90 days from the instrument's date of issuance. An extension of 90 days may be granted on a case-to-case basis in line with CareEdge Ratings' Policy on Assignment of Provisional Ratings.

Risks associated with provisional nature of credit rating

When a rating is assigned pending execution of certain critical documents or steps to be taken, the rating is a 'Provisional' rating indicated by prefixing 'Provisional' before the rating symbol. On execution of critical documents to the satisfaction of CareEdge Ratings, the final rating is assigned. In the absence of documents/ completion of steps or where such documents deviate significantly from those considered, provisional rating will be reviewed in line with the Policy on Assignment of Provisional Ratings.

About the originator / servicer and industry

Industry classification

Macroeconomic indicator	Sector	Industry	Basic industry
Financial services	Financial services	Finance	Securitisation

SSFL was incorporated on March 10, 2003, under provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and was registered as on non-deposit accepting non-banking financial company (NBFC) with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and was classified as an NBFC-MFI effective April 13, 2015. The company is engaged in undertaking microfinance loans business in India in a joint liability group (JLG) and loan against property (LAP) lending model. The company provides micro loans with a tenure of 1-2 years to women borrowers from low-income households for income generation activities such as agriculture, handlooms & handicrafts, cattle rearing, cottage industries & micro entrepreneurial ventures such as tailoring, and grocery stores among others, education and healthcare. The company has two subsidiaries, Caspian Financial Services Limited (CFSL) and Criss Financial Limited (CFL). As on December 30, 2025, the company operates in 19 states and one union territory with AUM of ₹3,295.85 crore. As on December 2025, SSFL has over 20 such, live pools amounting for ~₹3,000 crore.

Key financial indicators - SSFL

Brief Financials (₹ crore)	FY24(A)	FY25 (A)	9MFY26 (UA)
Total income	2,511	2,424	688.59
Profit after tax (PAT)	501	-1,035	-629.53
Assets under management (AUM)	11,973	6,819	3,295.85
On-book gearing (x)	2.70	2.65	2.14
AUM / tangible net-worth (TNW) (x)	3.43	3.19	2.14
Gross non-performing assets (NPA) / gross stage 3 (%)	1.68%	6.22%	2.60%
Return on managed assets (ROMA) (%)	4.25%	-8.82%	-13.31%
Capital adequacy ratio (CAR) (%)	31.95%	37.10%	30.43%

A: Audited; UA: Unaudited; Note: these are latest financial results available.

Key terms of Servicer Contract:

The servicing agreement shall cover role of the originator as the collection and payment agent (CPA) for the SPV in managing collections from underlying borrowers, who have consented to such assignment through provisions incorporated in the respective loan agreements. The servicer (originator) follows its standard procedures for collections, including recovery actions, and ensures timely transfers of funds to the SPV under an M+1 payment structure. The trustee monitors the sufficiency of funds for investor payouts one day prior to payout date and utilises CC in case of shortfall. The servicer must also submit detailed reports on billing, collections (including prepayment), overdue amounts with aging thereof, cash flow schedules to the trustee and such other information as may be required by the trustee. Terms of the agreement shall have provisions for the appointment of an alternate servicer in case of servicer event of default.

Status of non-cooperation with previous CRA: Not applicable

Any other information: Nil

Rating history for last three years: Annexure-2

Detailed explanation of covenants of rated instruments/facilities: Annexure-3

Complexity level of instruments: Annexure-4

Lender details: Annexure-5

Annexure-1: Details of instruments/facilities

Name of the Instrument	ISIN	Date of Issuance (DD-MM-YYYY)	Coupon Rate (%)	Maturity Date (DD-MM-YYYY)	Size of the Issue (₹ crore)	Rating Assigned and Rating Outlook
Pass Through Certificates	-	-	-	-	138.31	Provisional CARE AA-(SO)

Annexure-2: Rating history for last three years

Sr. No.	Name of the Instrument/Bank Facilities	Current Ratings			Rating History			
		Type	Amount Outstanding (₹ crore)	Rating	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2025-2026	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2024-2025	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2023-2024	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2022-2023
1	Pass Through Certificates	LT	138.31	Provisional CARE AA-(SO)	-	-	-	-

LT- Long term

Annexure-3: Detailed explanation of covenants of rated instruments/facilities

Not applicable

Annexure-4: Complexity level of instruments rated

Sr. No.	Name of Instrument	Complexity Level
1.	Pass Through Certificates	Highly complex

Annexure-5: Lender details

Not applicable

Note on complexity levels of rated instruments: CareEdge Ratings has classified instruments rated by it based on complexity. Investors/market intermediaries/regulators or others are welcome to write to care@careedge.in for clarifications.

Contact us

Media Contact Mradul Mishra Director CARE Ratings Limited Phone: +91-22-6754 3596 E-mail: mradul.mishra@careedge.in	Analytical Contacts Vineet Jain Senior Director CARE Ratings Limited Phone: +91-22-6754 3456 E-mail: vineet.jain@careedge.in
Relationship Contact Pradeep Kumar V Senior Director CARE Ratings Limited Phone: 044-2850 1000 E-mail: pradeep.kumar@careedge.in	Sriram Rajagopalan Director CARE Ratings Limited Phone: +91-22-6754 3652 E-mail: sriram.rajagopalan@careedge.in
	Chirag Ashwin Gambhir Associate Director CARE Ratings Limited Phone: +91-22-6754 3423 E-mail: chirag.gambhir@careedge.in

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